

Starmer Exits
With His Rival
At the Gates

Revolving Door of Prime
Ministers for Britain

By MICHAEL D. SHEAR

LONDON — For months, he tried desperately to avoid this moment.

But on Monday, Keir Starmer finally announced his resignation as prime minister, bowing to a long-simmering mutiny inside his Labour Party. The decision very likely paves the way for Andy Burnham, a popular former mayor, to become Britain’s next leader.

Mr. Starmer, who vowed as recently as Friday not to “walk away” from his job, said that he would remain in office only until a new party leader was selected. His decision to depart will usher in Britain’s seventh prime minister in a decade, extending a period of political turmoil in the country since it voted to leave the European Union in 2016.

“Every decision I’ve taken has been about putting the country I love first,” Mr. Starmer said in front of No. 10 Downing Street. “That is why I will resign as leader of the Labour Party.” His voice broke with emotion as he thanked his wife, Victoria, for being “a rock by my side.”

His departure will mark a bitter milestone for a party that made a remarkable comeback in 2024 after nearly a decade and a half in the political wilderness. With Mr. Starmer at Labour’s helm, the party won a large parliamentary majority and put an end to 14



Prime Minister Keir Starmer had led a comeback for the Labour Party in 2024.

years of government by the Conservative Party and its unpopular agenda of fiscal austerity.

But in an ominous sign for Mr. Starmer at the time, the Labour Party earned a record-low vote share of 34 percent in that general election, prompting many analysts to call the victory a “loveless landslide” that made his position inherently fragile from the start.

In office, Mr. Starmer increased military spending, raised investment in the National Health Service

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Analeidis Arias Matos getting her son, Alejandro, ready for school last month in Santiago, Cuba, during a prolonged energy crisis.

Ukraine’s ‘Fortress Belt’ Cities
Wither Under Russian Assault

By CASSANDRA VINOGRAD and OLEKSANDR CHUBKO

SLOVIANSK, Ukraine — Nadiya Trofimchuk, 79, had lived in the eastern Ukrainian city of Sloviansk her whole life and never thought about leaving, even as war raged for years not 20 miles away. Yet there she was one recent morning at a makeshift evacuation center, sitting next to a small folding table with water and tea but touching neither, just focused on leaving.

“We had a strike,” she explained, eyebrows raised over purple and gold cat-eye glasses. “A very, very, very big strike.”

In that April attack, Russia dropped a 3,000-pound bomb in the middle of the city, wiping out almost an entire block. It was a grim omen for Sloviansk and the rest of the Donetsk region, the Kremlin’s most coveted prize. Ukrainian forces have spent years fortifying and defending the strategic territory at immense cost, and it is now under an onslaught

Thousands Evacuate as
Putin Bombards the
Region He Covets

that residents fear is the beginning of the end.

The sense of foreboding in Donetsk is a sobering development for Ukraine at a moment when it has otherwise received a boost from a campaign of longer-range strikes and the stalling of Russian forces along most of the front.

Russia still has superior numbers and firepower. And after years of grinding warfare in the region, its forces have been concentrating on the “fortress belt” cities of Sloviansk, Kramatorsk, Druzhkivka and Kostiantynivka, part of the roughly 20 percent of Donetsk that Ukraine still controls.

Russian troops have fought their way into Kostiantynivka.

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U.S.’s Blockade of Oil to Cuba
Brings Its Schools to Standstill

By ED AUGUSTIN and FRANCES ROBLES

HAVANA — Axisa and Aron Alfonso, 6- and 7-year-old siblings in western Cuba, are luckier than most of their classmates: Their father takes them on their one-mile commute to school on horseback.

The children and teachers who live farther away rely on a spluttering, yellow Soviet-era school bus that no longer shows up. Teachers often do not make it to class, so the Alfonso family and their horse, Chocolate, turn around and go home.

A U.S. oil blockade has set off an increasingly agonizing energy crisis that has brought transportation largely to a standstill. Fewer cars and buses are on the streets, and, as a result, fewer students and teachers are in school.

“My children rarely go to school. They go, but the teachers don’t come,” said Sergio Alfonso Vázquez, 33, a farmer and the father of Axisa and Arona. “I’m afraid because they aren’t learning anything.”

To save energy, the Cuban government in February cut school to half-days and resorted to Covid-era remote learning for college students.

Then Cuba decided to end the school year two weeks early and scrapped college entrance exams for high school seniors after acknowledging that sleepless nights without electricity and a lack of school meals were exhausting students and teachers alike.

The Cuban government’s measures are the latest blows to the country’s once vaunted public education system, which had long been a signature triumph of the country’s socialist revolution.

Schools were already reeling

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Ending Year Early and
Scrapping College
Entrance Exams

CLIVE DAVIS, 1932-2026

Music’s Hitmaker, Kingmaker and Queenmaker

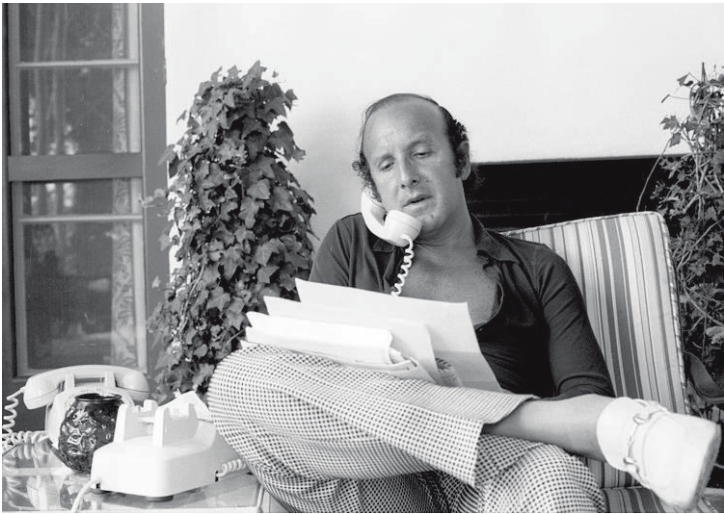
By BEN SISARIO

Clive Davis, the music executive who rose from a midlevel legal position at Columbia Records to become one of the industry’s most powerful and longest-reigning dons, guiding the careers of Whitney Houston, Aretha Franklin, Barry Manilow and dozens of other stars, died on Monday at his home in Manhattan. He was 94.

His family confirmed the death. Mr. Davis had recently been hospitalized with respiratory problems.

One of the few nonperformers in music to become a household name, Mr. Davis maintained a visible role as a starmaker for half a century. In the late 1960s he propelled a reluctant Columbia headlong into the rock era with acts like Janis Joplin and Blood, Sweat & Tears. He also encouraged the jazz trumpeter Miles Davis to connect with the Woodstock generation.

Later, at the Arista and J labels, he championed R&B-leaning pop divas like Ms. Houston, Alicia Keys and Jennifer Hudson; seized



Clive Davis propelled Whitney Houston, Billy Joel and more.

on the commercial potential for hip-hop; and orchestrated major career revivals for Carlos Santana and Rod Stewart, with albums selling in the millions.

For the public that saw him on television or in magazines, Mr. Davis was a mellow, dandyish eminence, seldom pictured in anything but a brightly accessorized suit. He spoke with an accent that hinted at European refinement, although his middle-class Brooklyn origins shone through when he referred, with affection, to “Arether.”

In the music industry, Mr. Davis

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ALAN GREENSPAN, 1926-2026

Leader in Shaping Economy Under 4 Presidents

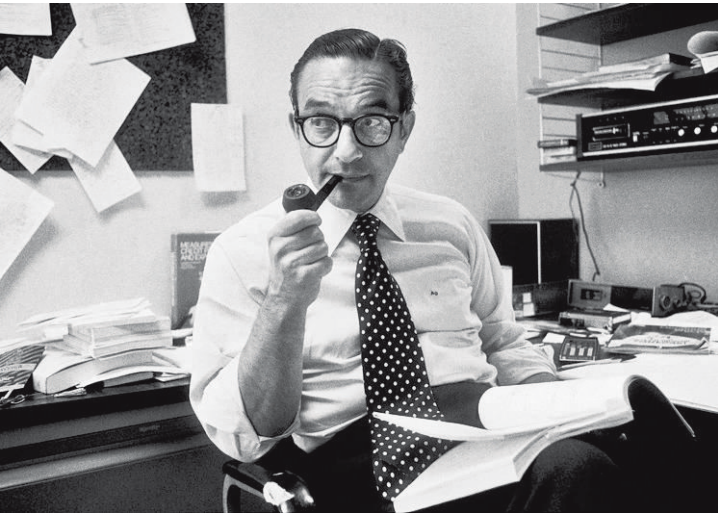
By RICHARD W. STEVENSON

Alan Greenspan, who in nearly two decades as chairman of the Federal Reserve nurtured a long run of prosperity, navigated crises and was a powerful and polarizing force in shaping market-friendly policies, died on Monday at his home in Washington. He was 100.

The cause was complications of Parkinson’s disease, his wife, Andrea Mitchell, the chief Washington correspondent and chief foreign affairs correspondent for NBC News, said in a statement.

The pre-eminent economic policymaker of his time and arguably the most recognizable economist of any era, Mr. Greenspan led the central bank under four presidents of both parties from 1987 to 2006.

Much of his tenure coincided with a streak of affluence in which he stood as the embodiment of a triumphant, post-Cold War strain of American capitalism: optimistic, faithful in the power of markets to improve living standards, captivated by the power of technology and averse



Alan Greenspan, a Republican with libertarian leanings, in 1974.

to regulation.

But the ideological stamp he put on policymaking came to be associated as well with the destructive consequences of forces that emerged on his watch, including deregulation of banking and Wall Street, the loss of American jobs to free trade and persistent concerns

about bubbles in stock and housing prices.

Even as Mr. Greenspan skillfully managed interest rates in a way that kept the economy humming along, he remained leery of confronting a danger he well recognized: that the low-inflation,

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A Second Home to Soccer Stars

The Pingry School in New Jersey has a tradition of hosting World Cup teams. Morocco is the latest guest. PAGE B6

Wyndham Clark’s Lonely Battle

“He was fighting everyone,” the golfer’s father said after a triumph over an unfriendly U.S. Open crowd. PAGE B7

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Radio Host Really Knows Wales

Elis James thinks he has a friend in common with just about everyone else in the country. Don’t believe him? Just give him 60 seconds. PAGE A4

A Trump Win in Colombia

Abelardo De La Espriella’s win may bring the nation back into President Trump’s graces. News Analysis. PAGE A8

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Cost of Brexit? Still Counting.

Economists say Britain’s economy is smaller than it would have been if it had stayed in the European Union. PAGE B1

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Etan Patz Conviction Restored

The Supreme Court reversed an appeals court ruling that a man convicted of murdering the 6-year-old boy was entitled to a new trial. PAGE A13

ICE Surge Exposes Rent Crisis

A relief bill and Minneapolis residents’ help for their neighbors might not be enough to stem a housing emergency laid bare by the crackdown. PAGE A10

National Parks’ New Normal

Huge visitor numbers, reduced staffing, scrapped reservation systems and higher entry fees for nonresidents could make your trip less serene. PAGE A14



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Underground View of the Sky

James Turrell’s “skyspace” installation, now on display in Denmark, forges a connection to the cosmos. PAGE C1

Making His Exit From Dance

Cory Stearns, a principal at American Ballet Theater, talks about learning that his time to retire had arrived. PAGE C1

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Immune Systems for Buildings

Spurred by the pandemic, the government is employing new technology to remove indoor health threats. PAGE D1

A Preference for Uncertainty

A researcher’s efforts helped lead to a genetic test for Huntington’s disease. But she wouldn’t take it herself. PAGE D1

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Philip Stephens PAGE A18

